Pieces of advice

for good questions - MTD UX

Intro

The Pieces of advice information sheet is intended to provide an overview of relevant aspects that are important when creating an interview questionnaire. It offers helpful tips on what should be used to achieve high-quality results, what should be avoided, and what should be taken into account in order to gain deeper insights during the interview process.

Please note: "Avoid" does not necessarily mean that these recommendations are strictly prohibited from being disregarded; rather, they serve as guidance to help improve the quality and effectiveness of the interview.

USE



Comfortable
The interview should take place at the location where the product is typically used or in a place where participants feel comfortable - preferably at home.



Broad & focus
Start with broad questions and gradually narrow your focus.



Simple
Ask simple questions.



Open
Ask open questions to get people into talking.



Dig depper
Ask questions to dig deeper. (If not why not?)



Mom Test
Is the question passing the Mom Test? Reminder: “Talk less and listen more.”



Neutral wording
Use neutral wording.

AVOID



Bias
Avoid biasing questions.



Technical terminology
Avoid technical terminology.



Yes/No
Avoid Yes/No answers. Choose carefully, only if you can live with a simple Yes/No or have prepared a follow-up “why?” question.



Hypothetical
Avoid hypothetical questions and answers (“I might”, “I could”).



Generic
Avoid generic questions and answers (“I usually”, “I always”, “I never”).



Leading/Suggestive
Avoid leading/suggestive questions.



Guesswork
Avoid guessing (Finding out is better).

AVOID



Selling Ideas
Not selling ideas.



Own Ideas
Do not mentioning your idea.



Opinions
Learn through their actions instead of their opinions.



Compliments
Not take them at face value.



Fluff
Generic claims & promises (not avoid these questions 100% of the time).

DIG DEPPER



Specific events
Seeking for specific events.



Love & hate
Talk about parts they love and hate.



Love bad news
Learn to love bad news (they getting us closer to the truth).



Facts
Collecting concrete facts.



Frustrations
Look for inconveniences, delays, and frustrations.



Real-action
Get as close to the real action as you can. (Seeing it first hand can provide unique insight) “Walk me through this process”

References

[1] Studyflix; Suggestivefrage (Video) Link: https://studyflix.de/jobs/karriere-tipps/suggestivfrage-6174/video cf. (own translation)

[2] M.Lewrick;P.Link und L.Leifer. The Design Thinking Toolbook. Die besten Werkzeuge & Methoden. ISBN: 978-3-8006-5751-3 Vahlen GmbH Verlag, München 2020. cf. p.60; p.63-64; p.71-72;

[3] R.Fitzpatrick. The Mom Test. How to talk to customers and learn if your business is a good idea when everyone is lying to you. (2013) CreateSpace Independent Publishing Platform ISBN/EAN: 9781492180746 cf. p.9-10; p.12-13; p.15-20; p.24

[4] D.Travis; P.Hodgson. Think like a UX Researcher. How to observe users, influence design, and shape business strategy. (2019) CRC Press. Taylor & Francis Group ISBN: 978-1-138-36529-2 cf. p.2-4; p.13; p.57